6.5 Esophageal Varices*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • Vomiting large volumes of fresh blood **Objective** • Known cirrhosis • BP 85/50 mmHg	**ACTUAL** Inadequate fluid volume related to variceal hemorrhage as evidenced by hematemesis and hypotension.	• Hemodynamically stable after treatment.	• Protect the airway; turn him on his side. • Give blood and a vasoactive drug such as terlipressin, as prescribed. • Prepare for endoscopic band ligation. • Give prophylactic antibiotics as ordered.	• Met when bleeding is controlled.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Blood in the airway • Reduced consciousness	**ACTUAL** Ineffective airway clearance related to blood in the airway as evidenced by gurgling respirations.	• Airway stays clear.	• Keep him on his side and suction as needed. • Give oxygen. • Prepare for intubation if ordered.	• Achieved while the airway is clear.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Portal hypertension • Recent variceal bleed	**RISK** Risk for excessive bleeding as evidenced by risk factors: varices and coagulopathy.	• No rebleeding.	• Once recovered, give the prescribed beta-blocker. • Teach the need to stop alcohol completely. • Make sure a repeat endoscopy is booked.	• Outcome reached if there is no further bleed.

* **References for this care plan:** [35], [46], [75], [128]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.